

Dashboard Design Brief

The Collection — Multi-Channel AI Lead Bot

Operator dashboard · functional & design specification

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1. Purpose & Audience

The dashboard is the single place the dealership owner runs everything the bot cannot do on its own — replying to escalations, seeing upcoming viewings, acting on re-engagement opportunities, and keeping inventory current.

One user, one problem: the dashboard is built for a single, busy operator who receives thousands of messages a day. Its core job is the opposite of most dashboards — not to show him everything, but to hide the noise and surface only what genuinely needs him. The bot handles the overwhelming majority of conversations silently; the dashboard is where the small remainder lands.

2. Design Principles

- **Attention first.** The default view answers one question: “what needs me right now?” Everything else is one tap away, not in his face.
- **Noise hidden by default.** Bot-handled conversations are stored and searchable, never the front-and-centre feed. He should never feel the firehose.
- **Mobile-first.** He will live in this on his phone between meetings and test drives. Every core action — reply, book, contact, mark done — must be one or two taps on a phone.
- **Few clicks to act.** Reading a ticket and replying, or contacting a re-engagement match, should never take more than a couple of steps.
- **Loud about urgency, calm otherwise.** Aging tickets and today’s appointments stand out visually; the rest of the interface stays quiet.
- **Photo-forward and premium.** These are luxury cars. Inventory and car references should show images, and the overall look should feel refined, not like a generic admin panel.

3. Information Architecture

Six primary screens, reached from a persistent navigation (a left sidebar on desktop, a bottom bar on mobile). Each nav item carries a count badge when it needs attention.

Screen	What it’s for	Primary actions
Home / Today	The morning glance — what needs you today	Jump to anything urgent
Conversations	Every thread across all 3 channels	Read, take over, reply
Tickets	Questions the bot couldn’t answer	Answer, resolve
Appointments	Upcoming viewings	View, reschedule, complete
Re-engagement	New stock matched to past requests	Contact, mark done
Inventory	Manage the cars (bot’s source of truth)	Add, edit, set status

4. Screens in Detail

4.1 Home / Today

The landing screen. One look should tell him everything that needs him today.

- **Shows:** today's appointments (count and list); open tickets needing a reply (count and the oldest one's age); new re-engagement matches (count); and a quiet line of context such as conversations the bot handled today.
- **Actions:** tap any card to jump straight into that section.
- **Empty state:** when nothing needs him, it says so plainly — “All clear” — rather than showing busywork.

4.2 Conversations (unified inbox)

Every customer thread from Instagram, WhatsApp and Messenger in one list.

- **List shows:** customer name/handle, a channel badge (Instagram / WhatsApp / Messenger), the last message snippet, timestamp, and a status tag — bot handling, needs human, or resolved.
- **Default order:** needs-human and recent threads first; the thousands of bot-handled conversations are reachable by filter and search, not shown by default.
- **Filters:** by channel, by status, and free-text search across customers and messages.
- **Open a thread:** full message history, who is currently handling it (bot or human), the customer context panel, and the reply composer.
- **Actions:** reply; take over from the bot; hand back to the bot; mark resolved; open the linked car or appointment; view the customer profile.

4.3 Tickets

The focused action queue: conversations the bot escalated because it could not answer confidently.

- **Each ticket shows:** the customer, channel, the unanswered question, the full conversation context, time opened, and a status (open / answered / closed).
- **Aging indicator:** tickets are colour-coded as they age (fresh → amber → red) and sorted oldest-first, so a slow ticket is impossible to miss.
- **Reply window warning:** a clear marker when the 24-hour reply window is closing, since after it a normal reply is no longer possible (WhatsApp needs a template; Instagram blocks it).
- **Actions:** open, read context, reply via the composer, and resolve.

4.4 Appointments

All upcoming viewings, drawn from the booking calendar.

- **Shows:** a list or calendar of bookings — customer, date and time, which car, channel, and contact — with today's appointments highlighted.

- **Actions:** view details, open the related conversation, reschedule or cancel (which updates the calendar), and mark completed or no-show.
- **Reminders:** a day-before reminder is sent automatically; the dashboard indicates when it has gone out.

4.5 Re-engagement

Turns new stock into warm outreach — the system’s sharpest feature.

- **Matches:** when a car is added or becomes available, this shows “N past customers wanted this car,” each with their contact, what they originally asked for, and when.
- **Open requests:** a running list of unmet “wanted” records, so he can see standing demand even before a matching car arrives.
- **Actions:** contact a match (a one-tap WhatsApp template where allowed, or opens the thread for him to message personally on Instagram); mark contacted, fulfilled, or dismissed.
- **Note on outbound:** matching and surfacing are unconstrained; the automated ping is limited by channel rules, so the screen makes clear which matches can be auto-messaged and which he should reach out to himself.

4.6 Inventory

Where the owner manages his cars — and the bot’s single source of truth for availability.

- **Shows:** a photo-forward grid of cars — image, make/model/year, price, status (available / reserved / sold), and key specs.
- **Add a car:** a simple form (make, model, variant, year, mileage, colour, price, photos, status). Adding or freeing a car is what triggers the re-engagement matching.
- **Actions:** add, edit, change status with a quick toggle, and search or filter the list.

5. Cross-Cutting Elements

- **Global search.** Find a customer, a car, or a conversation from anywhere.
- **Notifications & badges.** Count badges on the nav for new tickets, today’s appointments and new re-engagement matches; optional push or email for anything urgent.
- **Channel indicators.** A consistent icon and colour for each of Instagram, WhatsApp and Messenger, used everywhere a conversation appears.
- **Reply composer.** Shared by Conversations and Tickets; shows the 24-hour window status, supports the take-over-from-bot flow, and (later) saved quick replies.
- **Customer context panel.** On opening any thread: contact details, channel, a short history, the car they asked about, any booking, any open request, and whether the bot or a human is handling it.

6. Visual Design Direction

- **Aesthetic.** Premium, clean and uncluttered to match a luxury dealership — generous whitespace, strong typography, and car photos given room to breathe. Final brand colours to be confirmed with the client; a refined dark or neutral base with a single accent is the safe starting point.
- **Layout.** Persistent navigation, a main content area, and a contextual side panel for details (for example the customer panel beside an open thread). This collapses to stacked views with a bottom navigation bar on mobile.
- **Colour as signal.** Status colours are used sparingly and semantically — warm tones for aging/urgent, calm neutrals for handled — never decoration.
- **Responsive.** Designed mobile-first; the phone layout is the primary experience, not an afterthought.

7. A Day in the Dashboard

To anchor the design, here is how the owner actually uses it:

1. Morning: opens Home and sees three viewings today, two tickets waiting, and one new re-engagement match.
2. Clears the two tickets — reads the context, replies, resolves.
3. Glances at today's appointments so he knows who is coming and when.
4. Sees a car he just added matched four past requests, and taps to contact them.
5. Through the rest of the day, he only opens the inbox when a notification flags something needing a human — the bot handles everything else silently.

His total time in the dashboard is minutes a day, by design.

8. Data & Behaviour Notes

- **Sources.** Conversations, tickets and requests come from the backend database; appointments from the booking calendar; cars from the inventory database.
- **Real-time.** New tickets, messages and matches should appear without a manual refresh.
- **Performance at volume.** With thousands of conversations, lists must paginate or virtualize and default to filtered views (needs-human, recent) so the interface stays fast and uncluttered.
- **Access.** A single owner login for now, designed so additional staff seats with roles can be added later without rework.

9. Out of Scope (for this version)

- Buyer “hot-lead” scoring or ranking — dropped; serious buyers reveal themselves through bookings and requests.
- Deep analytics and reporting dashboards — a Phase 2 addition.

- Configuring the bot's prompts or logic — handled outside the dashboard.
- Multi-tenant or agency features — this is a single-business tool.